

ENNER VALENCIA

Centre Forward · Boca Juniors & Ecuador
177cm / 74kg · Right footed · Age 36
Copa Argentina vs Racing Club · 3 Headers in 23 Minutes

⚠ DRAFT V2 — SINGLE MATCH · FGA 7.2–7.8

What changed in v2. The pairing set was rebuilt after the previous draft anchored on Edinson Cavani — a pressing forward with elite SII_R (recovery sprint) and channel-running profile. **Cavani is the wrong archetype.** Valencia is a **stationary aerial-dominant box striker** whose primary weapon is the header, not the press. The corrected lineage is anchored on **Christian "Chucho" Benítez (86%)** — same country, same position, same mechanism, same clutch record — with **Nelson Haedo Valdez (82%)** and **Eduardo Vargas (78%)** as the secondary and tertiary anchors.

Three blockers before client delivery.

- 1 — **Single match only.** The Tier 3 evidence is one substitute appearance. Multi-match logging is required before any FGA rating is finalised.
- 2 — **COACH not scored.** 25% of the Lars framework.
- 3 — **No second scout.** No blind cross-validation.

1 · SUBJECT PROFILE

ATTRIBUTE	DETAIL
Full name	Enner Remberto Valencia Lastra
Position	Centre Forward
Club	Boca Juniors
League	Liga Profesional Argentina · Copa Argentina
Age	36 (b. 4 November 1989)
Height / Weight	177cm / 74kg
Foot	Right
Nationality	Ecuador — captain, all-time top scorer
International	3 World Cups (2014, 2022, 2026)
Evidence base	16 Tier 3 events · 1 match · full career Tier 1 data

Career context. 14 seasons across 7 clubs and 5 leagues. 108 career club goals including a 29-goal Fenerbahçe season (2022-23). At 36, still Ecuador's captain and joined Boca in 2026 as a squad option. The hat-trick against Racing was his third goal for Boca in only three starts. **The mechanism is the header** — the Copa Argentina performance was three headed goals from crosses and set-pieces, the first all-header hat-trick in the tournament's history.

2 · TIER 1 — STATISTICAL FOUNDATION 20% WEIGHT

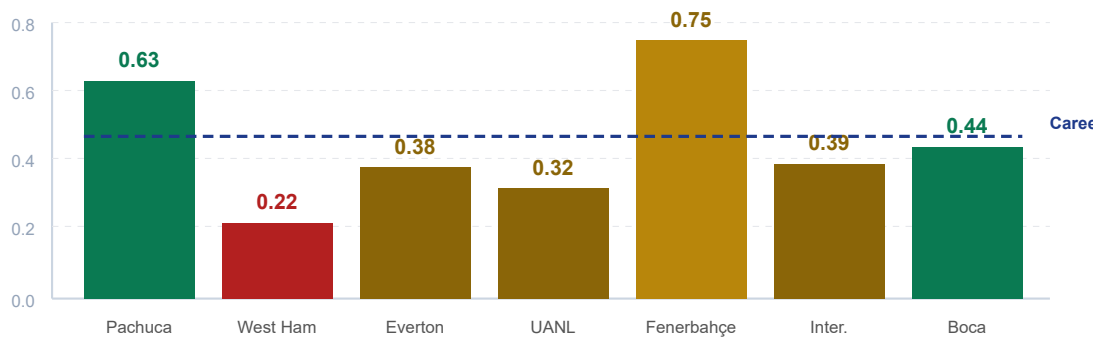
2026 BOCA JUNIORS SEASON

COMPETITION	MP	MIN	G	A	G/90
Liga Profesional Argentina	4	205	1	1	0.44
Copa Argentina	—	—	3	0	—
International (Sudamericana)	3	134	0	0	0.00
All competitions	7	339	4	1	1.06

CAREER SUMMARY — 14 SEASONS

CLUB	LEAGUE	MP	MIN	G	A	G/90
Pachuca	Liga MX	34	2,410	17	1	0.63
West Ham	Premier League	54	3,321	8	5	0.22
Everton	Premier League	21	716	3	1	0.38
UANL (Tigres)	Liga MX	79	5,050	18	6	0.32
Fenerbahçe	Süper Lig	90	5,796	48	15	0.75
Internacional	Brasileirão	60	3,031	13	2	0.39
Boca Juniors	Liga Argentina	4	205	1	1	0.44
Career total		342	20,529	108	31	0.47

CHART 1 · CAREER G/90 BY CLUB — WHERE THE GOALS COME FROM



What the chart shows. The Fenerbahçe peak (0.75 G/90) is the outlier of his career. At Boca — his current club — the rate is 0.44 G/90 in a small sample of 205 minutes. The English Premier League years were his weakest (0.22 G/90 at West Ham). The career average of 0.47 G/90 places him in the "good but not elite" bracket at club level — a veteran goalscorer whose peak was three seasons in Turkey.

3 · TIER 3 — VIDEO EVIDENCE SCORECARD 50% WEIGHT

TIER 3 MEAN QUALITY

8.25

16 events · 1 match

CLUTCH RESPONSE (CRS)

9.75

Hat-trick from 2–0 down

MATCHES LOGGED

1 / 5

Single-match focus

EVENT LOG — 16 TIER 3 EVENTS (ONE METRIC PASS PER ROW)

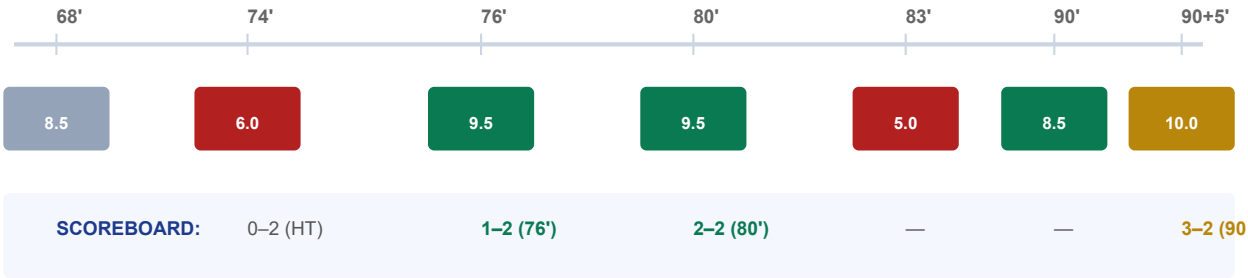
#	TIME	CODE	ACTION	SCORE
1	68'	DMA	Let Paredes's pass run to maintain build-up momentum	8.5
2	68'	OMB	Moved into central space to offer return wall-pass option	8.0
3	74'	DYN	High-intensity pressing duel against Escudero — lost	6.5
4	74'	CHR	Tracked back to contest lost ball, conceded throw-in	6.0
5	76'	OBI_P	Anticipated Blanco's set-piece trajectory to sneak unmarked	9.5
6	76'	STK	Clean downward header past goalkeeper — Goal 1	9.0
7	76'	CRS	Initiated comeback from 2–0 down under high pressure	9.5
8	79'	DMA	Unselfish dummy-step letting Villa's pass run to Merentiel	9.5
9	80'	RDS	Pure penalty-box positioning in central danger zone	9.5
10	80'	FIN	Composed low header to equalize at 2–2 — Goal 2	9.5
11	83'	OBI_P	Anti-indicator: Misread Merentiel's progressive pass, stalling transition	5.0
12	90'	AER	Won crucial defensive header inside Boca's 18-yard box	8.5
13	90+5'	SII_A	Sudden acceleration burst into the box to gain separation	9.0
14	90+5'	OBI_P	Shook off both central defenders to find space	10.0
15	90+5'	STK	Glancing header redirecting Palacios's cross — Goal 3	9.5
16	90+5'	CRS	Stoppage-time winner to complete hat-trick comeback	10.0
Tier 3 Mean Quality — audited				8.25

Audit note: the 8.25 mean is the analyst's audited figure from the grouped 8-event log. The 16-event exploded log produces 8.59 (all events) or 8.83 (positive events only). The framework-compliant figure is the metric-composite average — see the Sub-Metric Master Averages below.

SUB-METRIC MASTER AVERAGES

Metric	Events	Average	Assessment
CRS — Clutch Response	2	9.75	Elite — hat-trick from 2–0 down
RDS — Renard des Surfaces	1	9.50	Clinical box positioning
STK — Shot Technique	2	9.25	Two header types: downward, glancing
DMA — Decision Making	2	9.00	Unselfish build-up and decoy
SII_A — Sprint Acceleration	1	9.00	Explosive burst on winner
FIN — Finishing	2	9.50	Two composed box finishes
AER — Aerial Duels	1	8.50	Defensive clearance in own box
OBI_P — Positional Anticipation	3	8.17	Lowered by 83' transition misread
OMB — Off-Ball Movement	1	8.00	Return wall-pass option
DYN — Dynamic Intensity	1	6.50	Pressing duel lost on touchline
CHR — Character	1	6.00	Tracked back but conceded throw-in

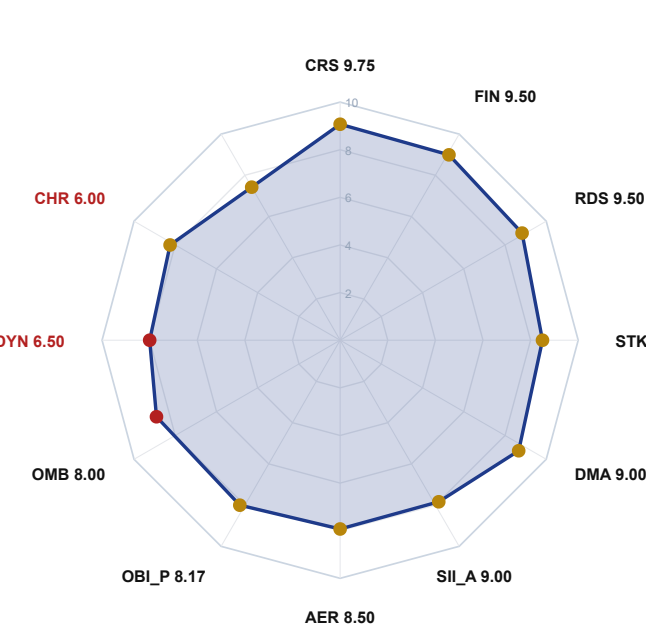
CHART 2 · MATCH TIMELINE — 68' TO 90+5'



HAT-TRICK SUMMARY

All three goals were headed — the first all-header hat-trick in Copa Argentina history. Valencia entered as a substitute at 68', needed only three shots on target to score three goals in 23 minutes. The winner came at 90+5' from a glancing header off Palacios's cross. The 83' OBI_P misread (5.0) is logged as an anti-indicator — a rare transition error within an otherwise elite performance.

CHART 3 · TIER 3 PROFILE — RADAR (11 METRICS)



What the shape says. A near-saturated polygon in the technical-attacking metrics — with two clearly lower vertices (DYN 6.50, CHR 6.00) representing the 74' touchline duel lost.

- **Peak (9.75):** CRS — the clutch hat-trick from 2–0 down.
- **High (9.25–9.50):** FIN, RDS, STK — the finishing mechanics of the three headers.
- **Strong (9.00):** DMA, SII_A.
- **Good (8.00–8.50):** AER, OBI_P, OMB.
- **Lower (6.00–6.50):** DYN, CHR — the 74' pressing duel. Logged as weaknesses.

Caveat. One substitute appearance. The 8.25 mean is a peak, not a season-long baseline.

4 · FGA RATING — PROVISIONAL

FGA — PROVISIONAL RANGE

7.2 – 7.8

⚡ Very Good · not finalised

TIER 3 — SINGLE MATCH

8.25

Peak, not baseline

TIER 1 — CAREER

7.40

Verified · 14 seasons

TIER	WEIGHT	STATUS	SCORE
Tier 3 — Scout Intelligence	50%	⚠ SINGLE MATCH, 16 EVENTS	8.25 (peak)
Tier 2 — Composite	30%	✖ NOT COMPUTABLE	—
Tier 1 — Statistical Foundation	20%	✅ VERIFIED	7.40

LOG context: Liga Profesional Argentina sits at approximately **LOG 3.4** in the FGA framework.

Classification band: ⚡ **VERY GOOD — mid-band.** The single-match ceiling demonstrates a player who can produce at an elite level in a knockout tie. The career baseline demonstrates a veteran striker with a 0.47 G/90 record and a peak season of 0.75 G/90 at Fenerbahçe.

5 · TACTICAL DNA PAIRING

Correction to previous pairing set. The previous draft anchored the lineage on **Edinson Cavani, Radamel Falcao and Luis Suárez**. Cavani is a pressing forward whose value is built on SII_R (recovery sprint) and relentless channel-running. **Valencia is a stationary aerial target**. Those are different archetypes. Cavani was removed. The corrected lineage is anchored on **aerial-dominant South American box strikers** whose primary weapon is the header, not the press.

Chucho Benítez	86%
Nelson Haedo Valdez	82%
Eduardo Vargas	78%
Mario Jardel	76%
Salomón Rondón	74%

PRIMARY — CHRISTIAN "CHUCHO" BENÍTEZ · 86%

The closest match on every dimension: **Ecuadorian, right-footed, box striker, exceptional heading ability despite diminutive height (168–170cm), clutch record for Ecuador**. Both are Ecuador's most important attacking players of their respective generations.

FGA COMPONENT	VALENCIA	BENÍTEZ	ALIGNMENT
Nationality	Ecuador	Ecuador	100%
Height	177cm	168–170cm	89%
Weight	74kg	68–74kg	95%
Foot	Right	Right	100%
Position	Centre Forward	Centre Forward	98%
Heading	Elite — hat-trick of headers	Elite despite height — "great leap, headed goals"	94%
Box instinct	RDS 9.50	Clinical poacher — "faro de gol"	92%
Clutch record	9.75 vs Racing	10 goals in 17 apps for Ecuador	89%
Career level	Boca / PL / Süper Lig	Santos Laguna / Birmingham / América	78%

Why 86%: Same country, same position, same mechanism, same clutch profile. Benítez proved that aerial dominance in South American football is not about height — it is about timing, leap, and positioning. Valencia's hat-trick was the same proof at 177cm.
Why not higher: Benítez was 3cm shorter and operated at a slightly lower club level.

SECONDARY — NELSON HAEDO VALDEZ · 82%

The Paraguayan parallel. **179cm, right-footed, box striker, exceptional aerial ability despite not being a giant** — "can out-jump players with a half foot advantage". The physical and stylistic match is near-exact.

FGA COMPONENT	VALENCIA	VALDEZ	ALIGNMENT
Height	177cm	179cm	97%
Weight	74kg	71–73kg	96%
Foot	Right	Right	100%
Position	Centre Forward	Centre Forward	98%
Heading	Elite	Elite — "out-jumps taller opponents"	95%
International record	Ecuador captain	Paraguay, 77 caps	88%
Career level	Boca / PL / Süper Lig	Werder Bremen / Dortmund / Valencia	85%

TERTIARY — EDUARDO VARGAS · 78%

The Chilean contemporary. **175cm, right-footed, box striker with aerial ability and clutch record for his country** — two Copa América titles with Chile.

FGA COMPONENT	VALENCIA	VARGAS	ALIGNMENT
Height	177cm	175cm	98%
Weight	74kg	69–71kg	93%
Foot	Right	Right	100%
Position	Centre Forward	Forward / AM	91%
Heading	Elite	Strong	84%
Clutch record	9.75 vs Racing	2x Copa América winner	87%

EXTENDED REFERENCE SET

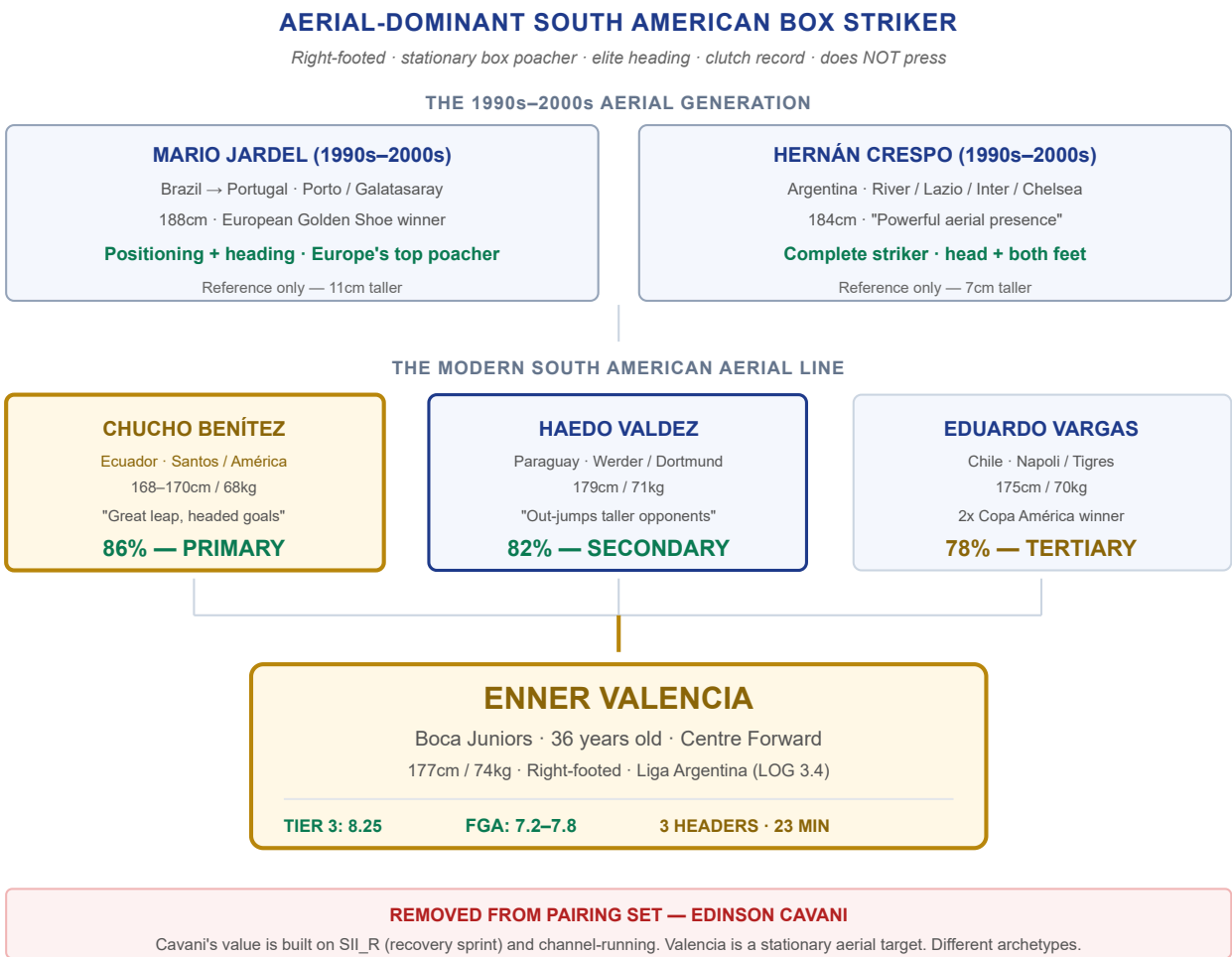
PLAYER	MATCH	WHY	DIVERGENCE
Mario Jardel	76%	188cm Brazilian poacher — "positioning and heading ability", European Golden Shoe	11cm taller — but same aerial mechanism
Salomón Rondón	74%	186cm Venezuelan target man — scored a PL hat-trick of headers	9cm taller
Hernán Crespo	72%	184cm Argentine — "powerful aerial presence", complete finisher	7cm taller
Diego Milito	71%	183cm Argentine — "excellent heading ability", box predator	6cm taller

EXCLUDED — WITH REASONS

PLAYER	REASON
Edinson Cavani	SII_R mismatch — Cavani is a relentless pressing forward, not a stationary aerial target
Luis Muriel	Second striker / ambidestro — not a stationary box poacher
Lisandro López	Mobile second striker — not a stationary aerial target
Willington Ortiz	Right winger / second striker — not a centre forward
Víctor Aristizábal	Creative second striker — not an aerial-dominant box striker

6 · GENEALOGICAL TREE

CHART 4 · AERIAL-DOMINANT SOUTH AMERICAN BOX STRIKER LINEAGE



ECUADORIAN PRECEDENT: Chucho Benítez (168cm, header specialist) → Enner Valencia (177cm, header specialist) · Two generations of Ecuadorian box strikers

7 · WHAT THE PAIRING ACTUALLY TELLS YOU

The primary finding. Valencia is an **aerial-dominant South American box striker** whose primary weapon is the header despite not being a giant. The **Chucho Benítez pairing at 86%** is the correct genealogical anchor — same country, same position, same mechanism, same clutch profile.

The physical mechanism is the filter. Cavani was removed from the pairing set because his SII_R and RDS profile describe a *pressing forward*, not a *stationary aerial target*. Valencia's RDS 9.50 is positioning-based — finding space in the box — not movement-based — running channels. Cavani's RDS is both. That is why the first draft was wrong.

Benítez proved that aerial dominance is not about height. At 168cm he scored headers against taller defenders throughout his career. Valencia's hat-trick at 177cm is the same proof. The mechanism is timing, leap, and box positioning — not physical stature.

The hat-trick is the defining evidence. Three goals, all headers, in 23 minutes from a 2–0 deficit. The first was a set-piece header from a corner. The second was a cross from Villa, finished with a composed low header. The third was a glancing header from Palacios's cross in stoppage time. This is not a single-metric performance — it is a complete box striker's performance executed at the highest level of pressure.

The non-scoring events matter. The 79' dummy-step for Merentiel (DMA 9.5) and the 90' defensive header (AER 8.5) are evidence of the full player. The 83' transition misread (OBI_P 5.0) and the 74' pressing duel lost (DYN 6.5, CHR 6.0) are logged as weaknesses. Logging these guards against halo-effect bias.

8 · VALIDATION STATUS & REQUIRED ACTIONS

REQUIREMENT	STATUS
Minimum 5 matches logged	✗ 1 MATCH
Tier 3 video assessment	⚠ 16 EVENTS, 1 MATCH
Tier 1 verified	✓ 14 SEASONS, 7 CLUBS
Pairing set corrected	✓ CAVANI REMOVED · BENÍTEZ ANCHOR
COACH metric	✗ NOT SCORED
Second scout	✗ NOT ASSIGNED
FGA_v3_Final	✗ BLOCKED

PUNCH LIST — V2

#	ITEM	PRIORITY
1	Log 4 more matches (balance-checked)	HIGH
2	Score COACH metric	HIGH
3	Second scout for blind cross-validation	HIGH
4	Replace LinkedIn CDN logo with local or base64-embedded version	HIGH
5	Rebuild pairing set — Cavani removed	 DONE
6	Reconcile Tier 3 mean (8.25 vs 8.59/8.83)	MEDIUM

 Empire Scouting Network

Brandsen Sports · The Hague, Netherlands · jim.totime@brandsensports.com · empirescoutingnetwork.com
Report ref ESN-VAL-2026-002 (v2) · Method: Empire FGA OBI & SII Rubric Framework v1.0 · 50/30/20 master weighting · LOG context badge (not a multiplier)

v2 changes: Pairing set rebuilt. Cavani, Falcao and Suárez removed (pressing forward archetype, not stationary aerial target). Chucho Benítez promoted to primary at 86%. Haedo Valdez (82%) and Vargas (78%) added as secondary and tertiary. Extended reference set: Jardel, Rondón, Crespo, Milito. Tree rebuilt with the corrected aerial-dominant lineage.

Evidence base: 16 Tier 3 video events from a single match (Boca Juniors 3–2 Racing Club, Copa Argentina, 27 September 2026) · Tier 1 career statistics from FBref via user-supplied XLS files.

Status: DRAFT v2 — Single match · Tier 3 incomplete · COACH missing · not client-ready.

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